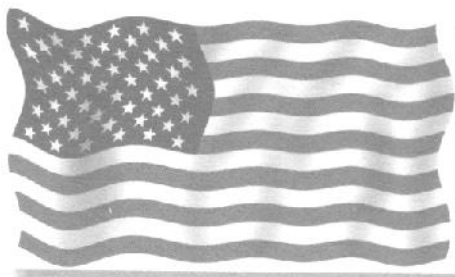


29 THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA



There is not a liberal America and a conservative America – there is the United States of America. There is not a black America and a white America and Latino America and Asian America – there's the United States of America.

Barack Obama

It's the movies that have really been running things in America ever since they were invented. They show you what to do, how to do it, when to do it, how to feel about it, and how to look how you feel about it.

Andy Warhol

□ VOCABULARY INPUT

Dealing with this topic you will come across the following vocabulary. Read it and look up the unknown words in your dictionary.

- **geography:**

- plains, rocky mountains, deserts, prairies, canyons, forests, coasts, beaches, reservations, national parks, waterfalls, caves, to share borders with, to be bounded by, to be located in the north, to lie between

- **economy:**

- industries: metals, minerals, raw materials, coal, oil, natural gas, iron, steel, glass
- agriculture: cotton, tobacco, corn, oranges

- **history:**

- discovered, colonised, settled, ruled by, governed, persecuted, declared, recognised, abolished
- colonists, puritans, settlers, rulers, Native Americans, slaves

- **political system:**

- federation, constitution, president, government (the Executive Branch, the Legislative Branch, the Judicial Branch)

- **population:**

- melting pot, multicultural society, immigrants, Yankees, Native Americans, African-Americans, Hispanic (Latino) Americans, The Amish population
- living the American dream, freedom, equality, fight against racism and terrorism

□ DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Before reading the text, discuss the following questions in class.

1. How many states does the USA consist of?
2. What is the capital of the USA?
3. Who is currently the American President? Is he popular among Americans?
4. Can you name at least three former American presidents?
5. What do you know about "the American dream"?

6. How do American films and adverts present Americans?
7. What do you know about the American way of life?
8. Which American cities would you like to visit and why?
9. Who do you think were the original American inhabitants?
10. Can you explain what the stars and stripes on the American flag stand for?

□ TEXT

Read the texts about different parts of the USA and find the places mentioned on the map provided. Check the meaning of the words in bold and answer the questions below.

THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA – GEOGRAPHY AND POPULATION



The United States of America is a federal constitutional republic consisting of 50 states including Alaska and the island of Hawaii.

Lying between the *Atlantic* and the *Pacific Oceans*, the *United States of America* covers a **considerable** part of *North America* and is nearly as large as Europe. The USA is **bounded** to the north by *Canada*, to the west by the *Pacific Ocean*, to the south by *Mexico* and the *Straits of Florida* and to the east by the *Atlantic Ocean*.

The most **densely** populated are the north-eastern states of *New York*, *Pennsylvania*, *Illinois*, *Ohio* and *Michigan*. This region includes some of the most important cities such as *New York* (14 million people), *Washington DC* (the capital of the USA), *Philadelphia* and the USA's biggest industrial centres, *Chicago* and *Detroit*.

The USA is home to more than 314 million people – mostly of European **origin** but also of African-American, Native American, Japanese and Chinese origins amongst others. Its multicultural character results from the large amounts of immigrants from all over the world. Besides English, which is the **official language**, the people of the USA speak their **minority** and immigrant languages. This means that Spanish is becoming an increasingly important language, especially in the southern states.

1. Using the map and the text above, describe the boundaries of the USA.
2. According to the text, which languages are spoken in different parts of the USA?

THE NORTHEAST

The northern region of the USA is called *New England*. It includes the states of *Connecticut, Maine, Massachusetts, New Hampshire, Rhode Island* and *Vermont*. It is the region where some of the first colonists settled. Old traditions are still **preserved**, especially in architecture and lifestyle. Some of the most famous universities, such as *Harvard* (1636) and *Yale* (1701), are in New England. They are private universities. The north-eastern region of the USA, which is rich in **raw** materials, has become the centre of industry. The USA is rich in most of the metals and minerals needed in basic industries. It has large resources of coal, oil, natural gas, iron, **steel** and glass.

3. What is the north of the USA famous for according to the text?
4. What industries are prevalent in the north of the USA?

THE MIDWEST AND THE SOUTH

In the centre of the USA, called the *Midwest*, there are **vast plains** where mainly **wheat** is grown. This is a region where agriculture is particularly well-developed. Much of the Midwest has windstorms, called tornadoes, several times each year, but they are short and affect small areas.

The Southern states of *Virginia, West Virginia, North Carolina, South Carolina, Kentucky, Tennessee, Georgia, Alabama, Mississippi, Louisiana, Florida* and *Arkansas* are mainly agricultural, **growing** cotton and tobacco. It is here that the **slave trade** started and transported Africans were used as slaves to work on cotton and tobacco plantations. Racial problems are still serious in the south. *The State of Florida* is different from the rest of the south. There are **pine** forests, orange plantations and beaches. This part of the country is often **severely** damaged by hurricanes.

The Southwest of the United States of America includes *Texas*, the largest state of the federation, famous for its oil, prairies and **cattle** ranches. There are also *New Mexico* and *Arizona* where many Native Americans still live on reservations. The Southwest with its **extensive** deserts is characterised by its **lack of** rain and extreme temperatures during summer. The famous *Grand Canyon* is situated in this region.

5. According to the text, compare and contrast weather conditions in the Midwest and the South of the USA.
6. What information does the text give about Native Americans and African-Americans?

THE WEST

The American West includes the following states: *Washington, Oregon, Wyoming, Montana, Utah, Idaho, Nevada* and *California*. They are also called the Rocky Mountains States. With the **exception** of its cities, the American West is very **thinly** populated. The natural beauties of national parks of this region of the USA are world famous. Thousands of tourists visit the *Rocky Mountains* and beaches in California every year. Visitors are also attracted to the cities of *California* such as *San Francisco* and *Los Angeles*. One of the most famous districts of Los Angeles, *Hollywood*, is the centre of both the **motion picture** and television industries.

7. Which natural beauties can be seen in the West of the USA?
8. What is Hollywood famous for?

OTHER ATTRACTIONS FOR TOURISTS

Besides southern California, there are also other tourist centres, such as the semitropical areas of *Florida, Hawaii, Puerto Rico* and the *US Virgin Islands* with fine beaches. Winter sports resorts can be found in beautiful areas in the *Rocky Mountains* and in *New England*. The Canadian-American *Niagara Falls* **belong** among the most beautiful natural wonders of the world.

9. What other attractions can be seen in the USA mentioned in the short paragraph above?
10. Which of them would you like to see and why?

□ VOCABULARY LIST

to belong – patriť
besides – okrem
to bound – tvoriť hranicu
cattle – dobytok
considerable – značný
densely – husto
exception – výnimka
extensive – rozsiahly
to grow – pestovať
lack (of) – nedostatok
minority – menšina
motion picture (AmE) – film

official language – úradný jazyk
origin – pôvod
pine – borovica
to preserve – zachovať
raw [rɔ:] – surový
severely – vážne
slave trade – obchod s otrokmi
steel [sti:l] – oceľ
thinly – riedko
vast plain – rozsiahla pláň
wheat – pšenica

□ VOCABULARY PRACTICE

Task 1 Brainstorm whatever comes to mind in connection with the USA. Put your ideas into the categories listed below.

AMERICAN STATES: _____

AMERICAN CITIES: _____

AMERICAN PRESIDENTS: _____

AMERICAN NATIONAL ICONS: _____

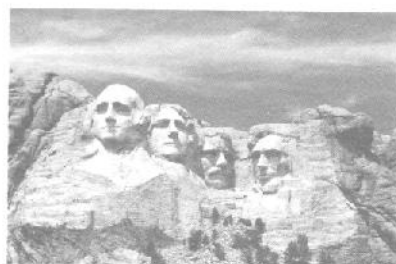
AMERICAN CELEBRITIES: _____

AMERICAN WRITERS: _____

AMERICAN SPORTS: _____

AMERICAN FOOD: _____

Task 2 Look at the photographs taken in different parts of the USA. Do you know anything about these sights and places? Where are they? What are they famous for? Find interesting pieces of information about these places on the Internet and present your findings to your class in the form of a PowerPoint presentation.



1. _____



2. _____



3. _____



4. _____



5. _____



6. _____



7. _____



8. _____



9. _____



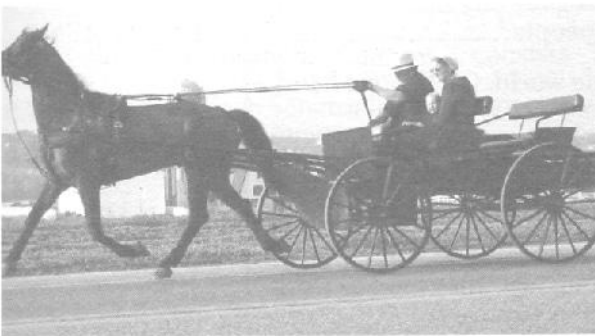
10. _____

□ LISTENING

Task 3 The Amish People



You are going to hear a text about the Amish population living in Pennsylvania, the USA. For questions 1–6, choose the best alternative (A), (B) or (C). There is always only one correct answer. Listen to the recording twice.



1. What is said about the Amish?

- A) They reject family life.
- B) It is difficult to make friends with them.
- C) They are very religious.

2. What is NOT true about the Amish?

- A) They do not use cars.
- B) They are not allowed to watch television.
- C) They are allowed to use electricity.